

Literature Review

Transit and The World Cup in the Greater Boston MSA

1 Introduction

I began this literature review considering these three research questions:

1. Are Greater Boston MSA neighborhoods with greater socioeconomic disadvantage disproportionately affected by unreliable transit?
2. How does Greater Boston MSA transit accessibility shape access to employment opportunities?
3. Do weather-related transit disruptions in the Greater Boston MSA disproportionately affect disadvantaged communities?

I settle on a synthesis of these three research questions to better fit this course and contribute to the literature. In the curated source list below, I place emphasis on the sources that best fit this synthesis.

2 Curated Source List

2.1 Theory

1. Martens, Karel. 2017. *Transport Justice: Designing Fair Transportation Systems*.
2. Lucas, Karen. 2012. "Transport and Social Exclusion: Where Are We Now?" *Transport Policy* 20:105–13. doi: [10.1016/j.tranpol.2012.01.013](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tranpol.2012.01.013).
3. Pereira, Rafael H. M., Tim Schwanen, and David Banister. 2017. "Distributive Justice and Equity in Transportation." *Transport Reviews* 37(2):170–91. doi: [10.1080/01441647.2016.1257660](https://doi.org/10.1080/01441647.2016.1257660).

2.2 Methodology

1. Allen, Jeff, and Steven Farber. 2019. "Sizing up Transport Poverty: A National Scale Accounting of Low-Income Households Suffering from Inaccessibility in Canada, and What to Do about It." *Transport Policy* 74:214–23. doi: [10.1016/j.tranpol.2018.11.018](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tranpol.2018.11.018).
2. Draper, Stephen. 2017. *Definitions of Railway Performance Metrics*. Rail Delivery Group.
3. Fu, Liping, and Yaping Xin. 2007. "A New Performance Index for Evaluating Transit Quality of Service." *Journal of Public Transportation* 10(3):47–69. doi: [10.5038/2375-0901.10.3.4](https://doi.org/10.5038/2375-0901.10.3.4).

4. Lyu, Duanya, and Xiang Yan. 2026. "Analyzing the Impact of Service Frequency and On-Time Performance on Transit Ridership in Miami-Dade County." *Transportation*. doi: [10.1007/s11116-026-10742-w](https://doi.org/10.1007/s11116-026-10742-w).
5. Welch, Timothy F., and Sabyasachee Mishra. 2013. "A Measure of Equity for Public Transit Connectivity." *Journal of Transport Geography* 33(C):29–41.

2.3 Context-Specific Research

1. Pereira, Rafael H. M. 2018. "Transport Legacy of Mega-Events and the Re-distribution of Accessibility to Urban Destinations." *Cities* 81:45–60. doi: [10.1016/j.cities.2018.03.013](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cities.2018.03.013).
2. Pereira, Rafael H. M. 2021. "Transport Legacy of Mega-Events and Inequalities in Access to Opportunities in Rio de Janeiro." in *Urban Demographics*. London, U.K.: Routledge.

2.4 Justification

I selected sources that fit my research question, were well-cited and supported, and were largely peer-reviewed. Beginning with theory, I chose Martens (2017), which is a foundational text linking sociology to transportation. Concurrently, Lucas (2012) provides the evolution of transportation and social exclusion over history. Finally, Pereira, Schwanen, and Banister (2017) contributes a qualitative perspective on the justice of transportation, which supports the relevance of my research question.

Second, I needed a robust selection of methodological resources to understand how best to conduct this research. I looked to Fu and Xin (2007) for how to measure performance, Welch and Mishra (2013) for how to measure equity, and Lyu and Yan (2026) for how to measure satisfaction. Draper (2017) provides a comprehensive overview of existing railroad performance metrics for consideration, and Allen and Farber (2019) provides a battle-tested socioeconomic status measure perfect for transportation-related research.

Finally, I took advantage of context-specific research to understand the impact of the World Cup (as a proxy for large scale events and/or disasters) on transit equity. Pereira (2018) and Pereira (2021) provide this valuable context.

3 Mapping the Intersection of Sociology and Transportation

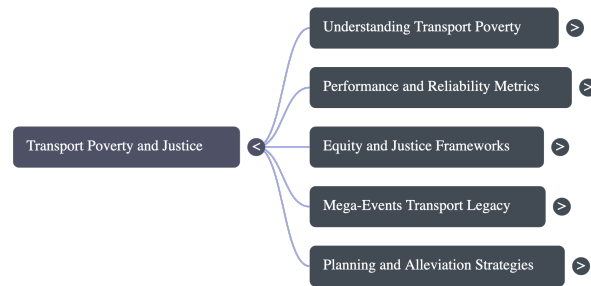


Figure 1: NotebookLM Mind Map

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